



PHOTO BY **MILIND SHELTE**

At L&T's scale, a conversation on sustainability would include large international projects or the bullet train in India, sewage treatment plants (STP), among others. Singh elaborates on the STP project in Mumbai, where L&T is constructing a 360 million litres per day plant

at Bandra's reclamation area. Again, Mumbai's coast is known to be highly polluted. "From L&T's point of view, we have our own water R&D facility at Kanchipuram (in Tamil Nadu), and that gives us a lot of expertise," says Singh. The company is already involved in the National

IT IS ALREADY INVOLVED IN THE NATIONAL MISSION FOR CLEAN GANGA TO EXECUTE PROJECTS AT SCALE

Mission for Clean Ganga (Namami Gange), to execute projects at scale around STPs and underground sewerage networks, to prevent untreated water from being discharged into the rivers.

In markets like West Asia, a lot of work is done on renewable energy, more specifically around solar. In India, it has been a part of the Omkareshwar floating solar project in Madhya Pradesh. "For solar to take off in a big way, it has to be with storage, and that could be either battery or pump," says Singh. **43**

Complexity comes with each project, and he cites the case of hydel in the Himalayas, where the ecosystem is fragile and prone to landslides. "Getting it right here is critical, and the region has had a history of projects not taking off. Plus, the terrain is tricky, where a geology-based tech approach is needed. Typically, you design all this for at least fifty years," he explains.

Sustainability comes with an innovation component as well. Last year, L&T had a Rs 500 crore ESG bond issuance deal, marking the first instance of an Indian company taking that route. **BT**

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